RITUAL FOUNDATIONS

Petitions & Written Will

Clear words for prayer, protection, prosperity, and personal direction

SHRINE OF THE INNER THRONE

Adorn the seat of your soul.

CHAMBER 01

Begin with What You Need

A petition gives your prayer words you can return to.

Cultural Ground

Name papers, prayer papers, and petition papers have a place in African American Hoodoo. Written words may accompany roots, candles, containers, and other work. Sources 1-2 provide practitioner context; methods vary.

The Shrine's templates below are original examples. You may pray in language that fits your own sincere beliefs. Plain paper and a pen are enough.

A Useful Starting Point

- Name the subject: yourself, your household, a project, or a condition.
- Name the movement: protect, strengthen, welcome, reveal, complete, release.
- Name your responsibility: the action you will take alongside the prayer.

CHAMBER 02

Petition and Use

Start with a sentence that says what you mean.

Five Ready-to-Adapt Examples

- Protection | Use: household peace and boundaries. 'May my home remain a place of safety, privacy, and mutual respect.'
- Prosperity | Use: fair pay and good opportunities. 'May my work meet the people it can serve, and may our exchange be fair and fruitful.'
- Power | Use: confidence and self-direction. 'May I speak clearly, trust sound judgment, and act with courage.'
- Clarity | Use: decisions and discernment. 'May the facts become clear, and may I recognize my next wise step.'
- Love | Use: mutual affection and welcome. 'May the love I give and receive be honest, kind, and freely chosen.'

Make It Yours

Add the situation you actually face, without promising certainty or demanding control of someone else. Write an observable next step beneath the petition. Keep that practical note separate if you prefer your prayer to remain brief.

CHAMBER 03

Form, Fold, and Placement

A meaningful gesture can be simple.

Methods and Their Context

- Plain paper: use a small piece that fits where you will keep it. Specialty paper is optional.
- Names: write your own name or a relevant household or project name. Treat other people's information privately.
- Crossing: some rootworkers cross a written name with another name or phrase. Study the specific method before adopting it; our starter practice does not require it.
- Folding: practitioner guidance includes folding toward oneself for drawing and away for losing or releasing (Source 2). Direction and repetition vary.
- Placement: keep your paper in a journal, beside an unlit object, or inside a suitable ritual container. Keep paper outside any candle's heat and flame area.

No Required Number

Our examples do not require a fixed number of names, turns, or folds. If you inherit a specific method, learn why it is done that way rather than treating every variation as an error.

CHAMBER 04

Write a Petition You Can Use

An original Shrine practice.

The Practice

1. Write your name or the subject at the top of a small paper.
2. Choose one purpose and write a short prayer beneath it.
3. Read it aloud. Replace any vague phrase with words that fit your actual situation.
4. On a separate note, write what you can do within the next two days.
5. Fold the petition if you wish and keep it somewhere private.
6. Return to the prayer when useful, complete your action, and review after a week.

May my prayer be clear, my judgment steady, and my actions faithful to my words.

Example in Practice

For a work opportunity, keep a prosperity petition in your journal. Beside it, list one application, conversation, or proposal you can complete. The petition holds the prayer; the checklist helps you follow through.

CHAMBER 05

Review and Close

A completed petition can become a record of learning.

Keeping or Releasing the Paper

Record what occurred without treating every coincidence as fulfillment. Keep a meaningful petition in your journal, or shred it when the work is complete. Burning and outdoor burial are unnecessary.

When the paper includes private names or details, protect them. Do not publish someone else's petition as content without permission.

Reflect

- What was I asking for?
- What part was mine to act on?
- What did I learn about the request?

Sources

- 1. catherine yronwode, Paper in My Shoe: book overview.
- 2. Lucky Mojo, Petition Papers discussion: folding guidance.

Closing

Write plainly. Pray sincerely. Let your conduct support the words.